

PLAYER MANUAL

INK SQUADRON

Draw your battle. Lead your squadron.

Everything you need to know to fly, fight and win.
Version 2.0

GETTING STARTED

Welcome, pilot!

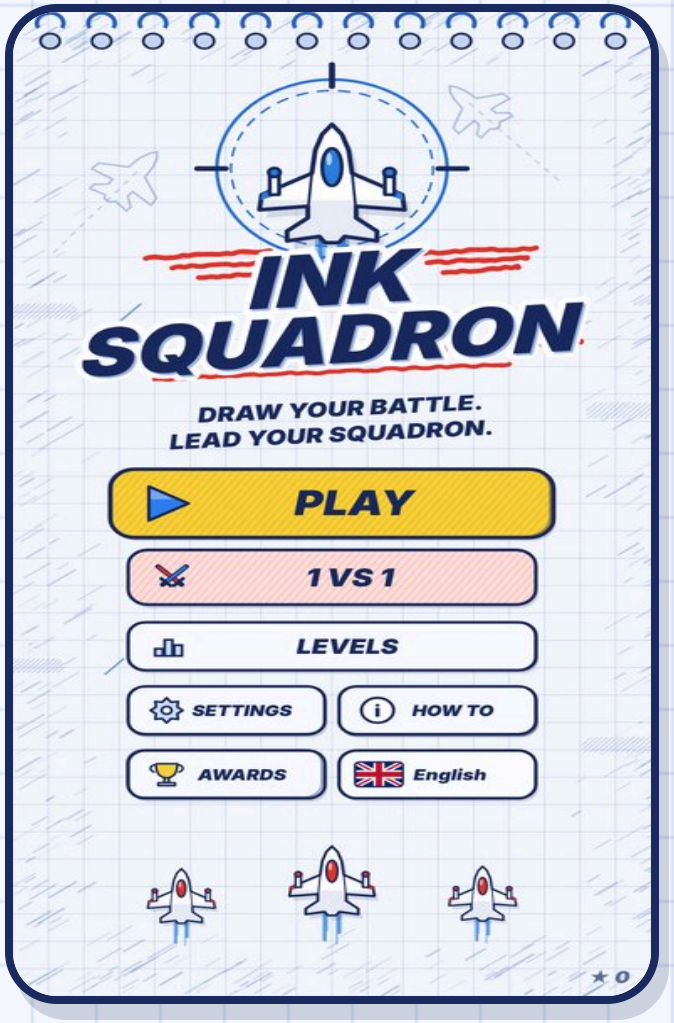
1. **Pick your language & name**
   On the very first launch, tap a flag, then type your pilot name. You can change it any time in Settings, or with the flag button on the main menu. 8 languages are included.

2. **Tap PLAY**
   Choose a mode: **Classic** (dice, turn by turn), **Arcade** (real-time waves) or **Time Attack** (beat the clock). Every battle opens with **GET READY!** while the battlefield is drawn.

3. **Challenge a friend**
   1 VS 1 on one phone, face to face, or on two phones over Wi-Fi / Bluetooth.

4. **Collect stars & awards**
   Every Classic level gives up to 3 stars. 19 awards to unlock (also on Google Play Games).





MODES

Choose your battle

Classic

The original table game. Roll the die, draw your missile, outsmart the enemy. 100 levels with bosses, new enemy types and surprises.

Arcade

Real-time action. Hold your guns to draw. Endless waves, a bonus stage every 5 waves, 3 credits to keep going.

Time Attack

60, 120 or 180 seconds. Score as much as you can. Every wave you clear adds 5 seconds.

1 VS 1

Two pilots. One phone (turn-based or real-time) or two phones over Wi-Fi / Bluetooth.



CLASSIC · BASICS

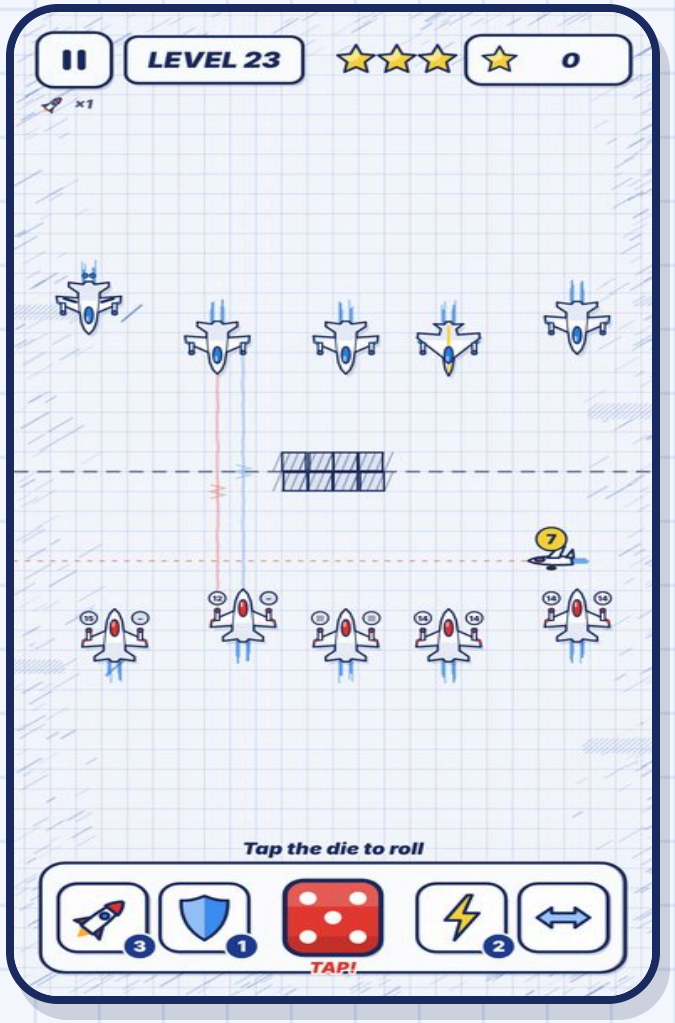
Roll & draw

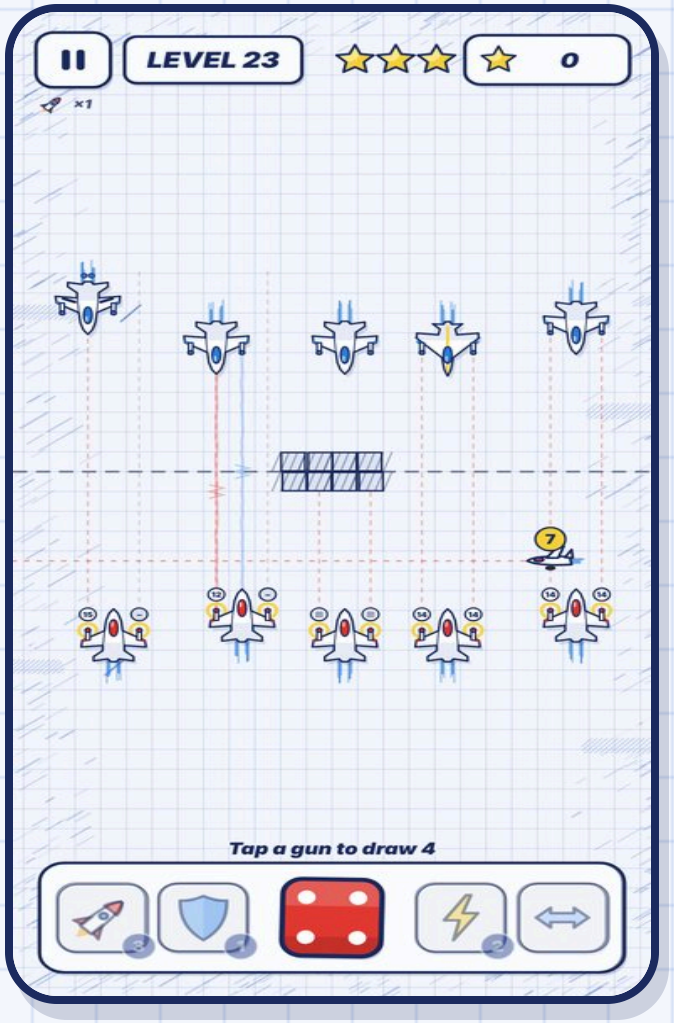
1. **Tap the red die**
   You roll 1–6.

2. **Tap one of your guns**
   Guns sit on your wing tips (yellow rings). Your ink missile grows straight ahead by the number you rolled. Hold your finger to preview: the label says **HIT!**, **CUT**, **MISS** or **+n**.

3. **Read the bubbles**
   The number next to each gun is how many squares are still needed to hit. A **yellow** bubble is within one roll (6 or less). **–** means nothing to hit in that lane.

4. **Take turns**
   Then the enemy does the same. Destroy the whole enemy squadron to win.

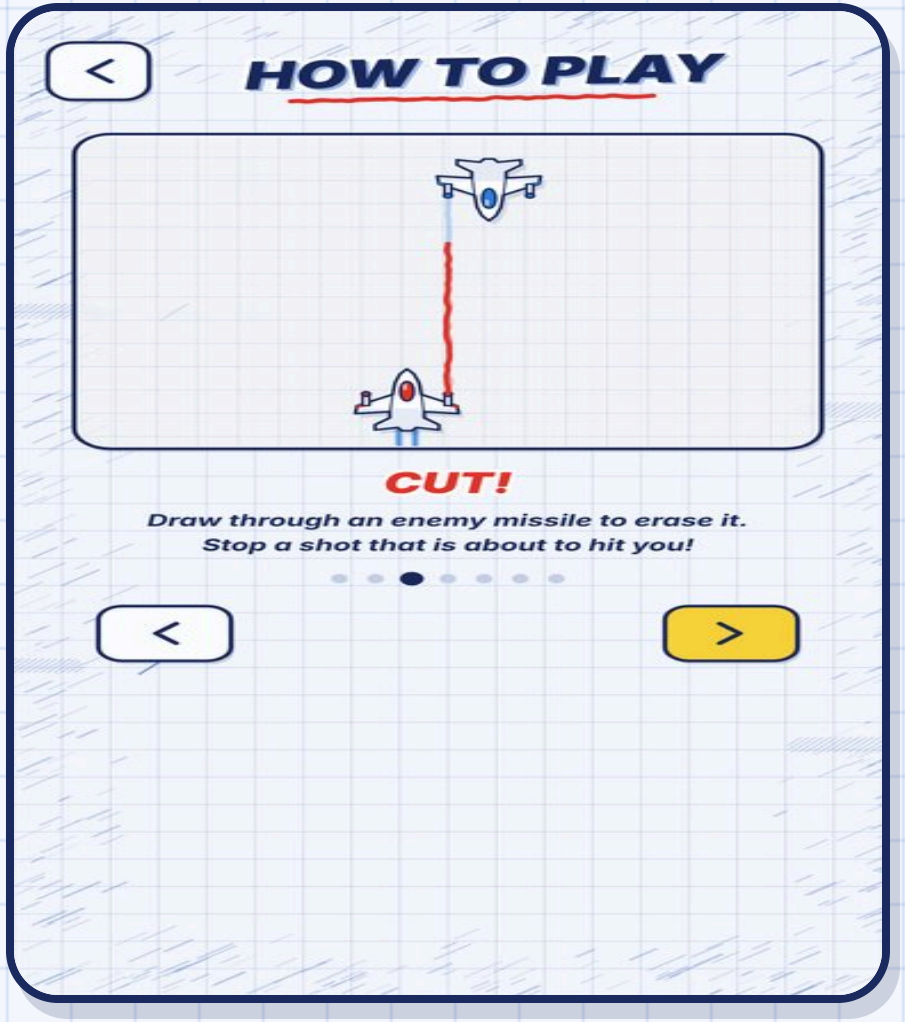




CLASSIC · TACTICS

Hits, cuts & lanes

Rule	What it means for you
HIT	A missile that reaches an enemy ship damages it. Fighters fall with 1 hit, armored ships need 2, tanks 3 (the small dots under a ship show its health).
CUT!	If your missile runs through an enemy missile in the same column, it erases it and keeps going. The best defence against a shot that is about to hit you.
Nose lanes	A lane aimed at the **centre** (nose) of an enemy ship can't be cut, because there's no enemy gun there. Find these lanes!
Empty lanes	A missile with nothing in front of it flies off the page (MISS). If no lane has a target, MOVE a ship.
MOVE	Slide a ship 1 square sideways. Uses your turn and erases that ship's lines, but can open a new lane (or dodge one).



CLASSIC · TRAY

Power-ups

Your tray at the bottom of the screen holds four tools. The small number is how many you have left. You get a fresh kit every level.

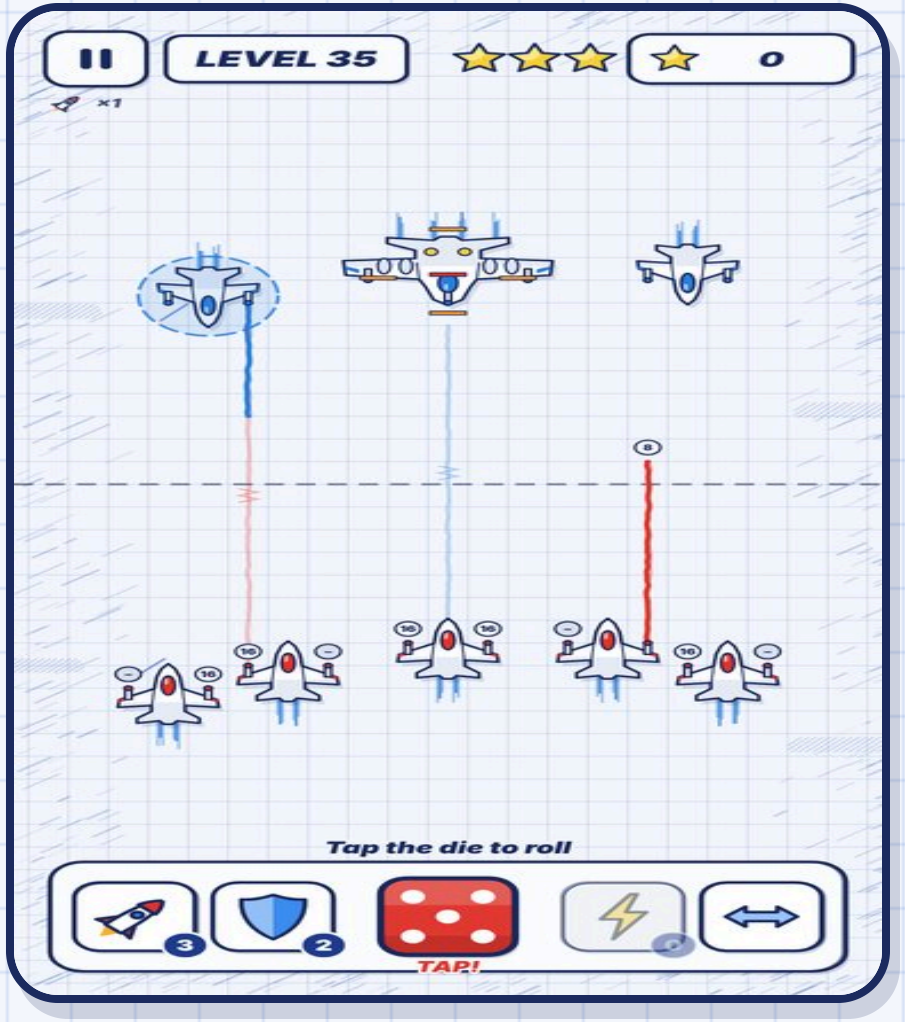
Tool	Effect	Costs your turn?	How to use
🚀 **Rocket**	Your missile jumps +6 squares at once	Yes	Tap the rocket, then a gun
🛡 **Shield**	Blocks the next hit on one ship	No (free)	Tap the shield, then one of your ships, then roll as usual
⚡ **Lightning**	Roll two dice this turn and use both	No: you still roll	Tap the bolt, then the die
↔ **Move**	Slide a ship one square left or right	Yes	Tap move, a ship, then an arrow

The enemy gets power-ups too as the levels go up; its counts are shown under the top bar.

CLASSIC · ENEMIES

Know your enemy

Ship	From level	What it does
Fighter	1	2 guns, 1 hit
Armored	4	Thick plates: 2 hits
Interceptor	6	Yellow stripe. Hops sideways now and then
Bomber	11	Wide, **4 guns**, 2 hits
Tank	16	One nose cannon, 3 hits
Sniper	22	Long nose, each shot reaches 1 square further
BOSS	every 5th	Huge, with **parts**: shoot off the wings (their guns stop), the nose gun, then the engines (it stops moving), then the **core**. It moves in 4 directions.



CLASSIC · SURPRISES

Dangers & help

💣 Bomber raid

A small bomber crosses the page from level 10. The yellow number is the turns left before it escapes. Have a missile line in its path to shoot it down, or it drops a bomb on your nearest ship.

🧱 Bunkers

From level 21 some levels have blocks in the middle. A missile that hits a block breaks it and stops. It takes a few shots to clear a lane.

✈ Reinforcements

On later levels a fresh enemy fighter flies in after some rounds. The top bar counts down.

⚡ Overdrive

If nobody gets hit for a long time, every roll gets +1, then +2... The battle always ends.

📦 Supply drop

Stuck on a level? After a couple of defeats you start the level with extra shields and rockets, and the enemy plays a little worse. Win once and it's back to normal.



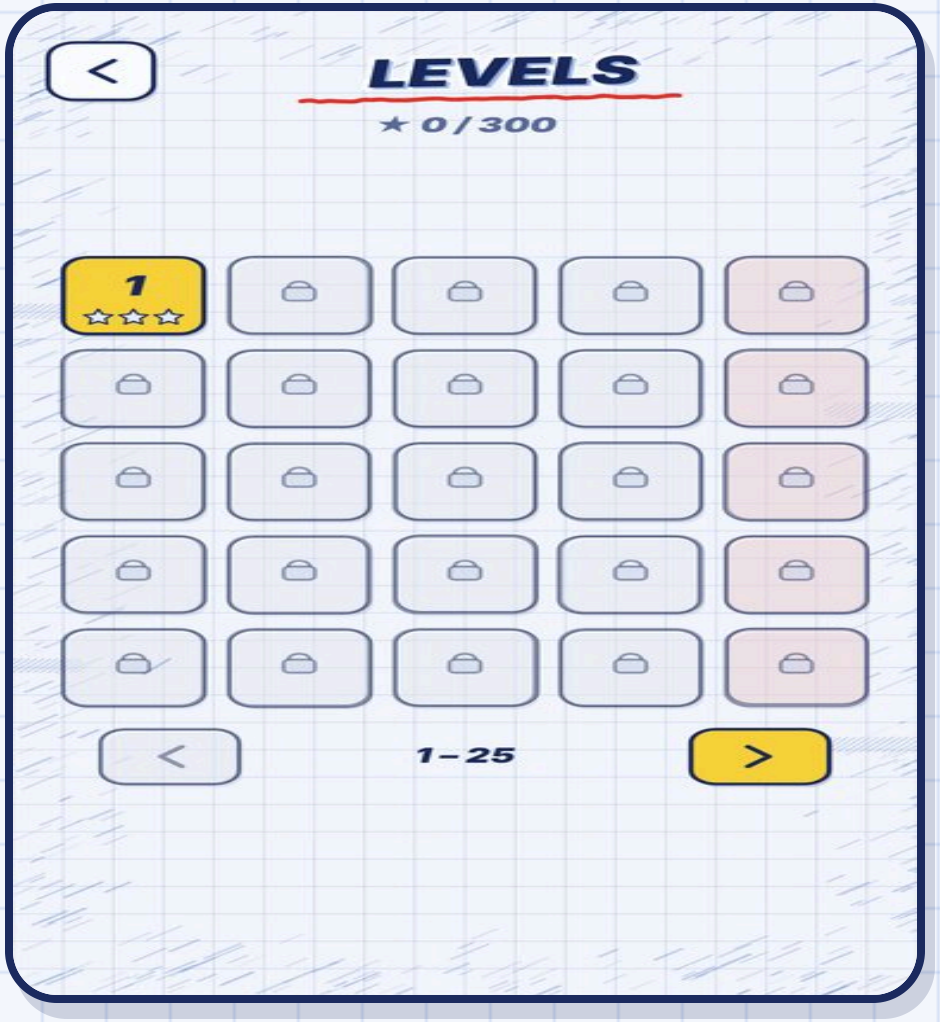
CLASSIC · PROGRESS

Stars, score & levels

Stars	When
★★★	You win without losing a ship
★★☆	You lost up to half of your ships
★☆☆	You won, but only just

Points	
Hit / Cut	100 / 50
Ship destroyed	250
Bomber shot down	200
Each surviving ship	200
Level bonus	30 × level

Your best score per level is kept. The ★ total on the menu adds them all up. Replay any unlocked level from **LEVELS**; boss levels are marked with a crown.



ARCADE

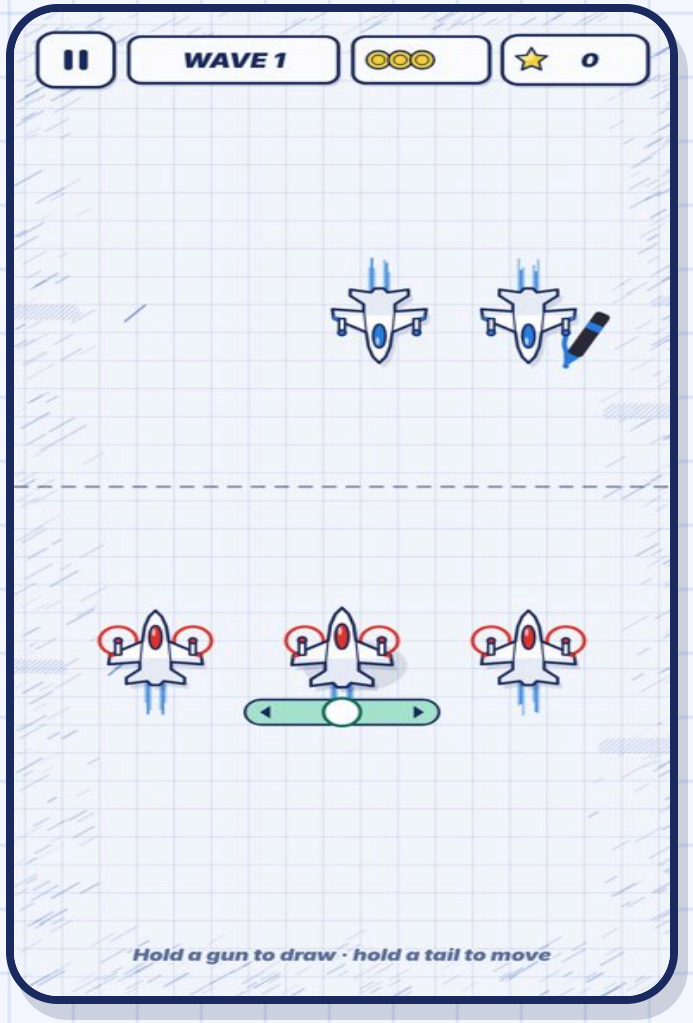
Real-time waves

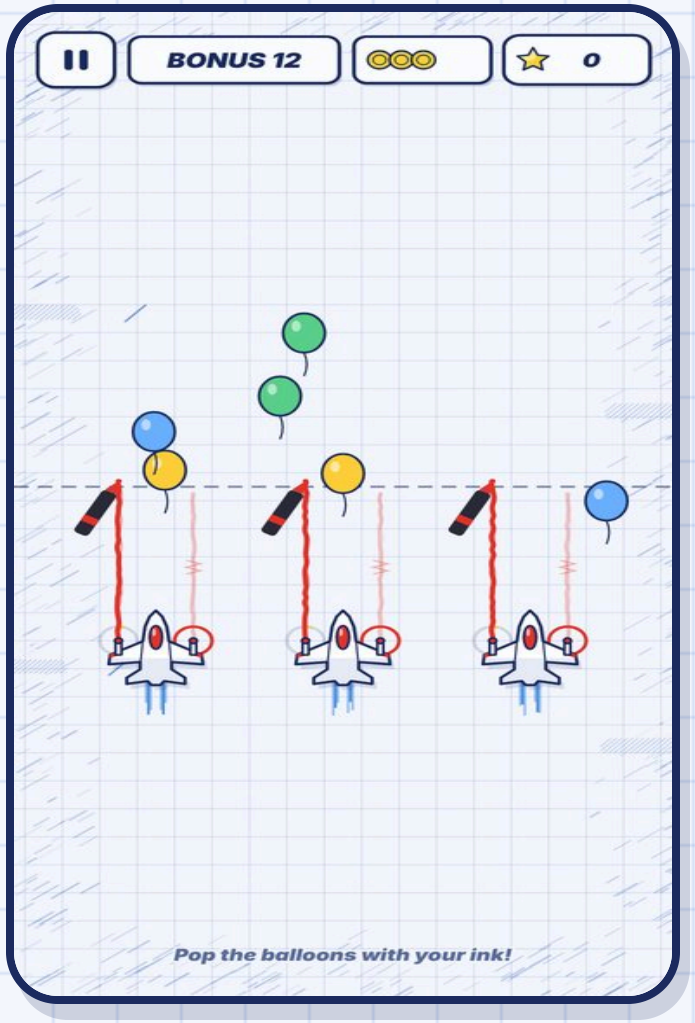
1. **Hold a gun to draw**
   No dice here: keep your finger on a gun and the line grows. Use several fingers on several guns.

2. **Watch the ink ring**
   Each gun has its own ink. The ring around it empties while you draw and refills by itself.

3. **Hold a tail to move**
   Keep a finger on a plane's tail for a split second (0.15 s): it lifts and a lever appears. Slide left or right, then let go.

4. **Warp & bonus**
   Every 3 waves you **warp** to a new sector (bunkers included), then **READY? 3-2-1**. Every 5 waves a bonus stage: every 6 balloons popped = +1 credit (max 3), and your squadron is repaired.





ARCADE & TIME ATTACK

Credits & CONTINUE?

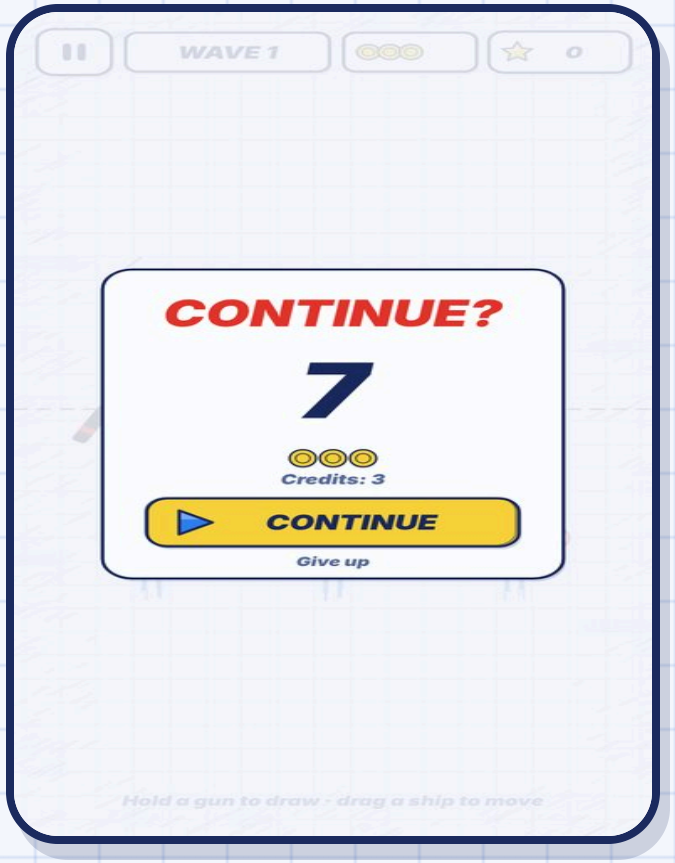
Like a classic coin-op: every run starts with **3 credits** (the coins in the top bar).

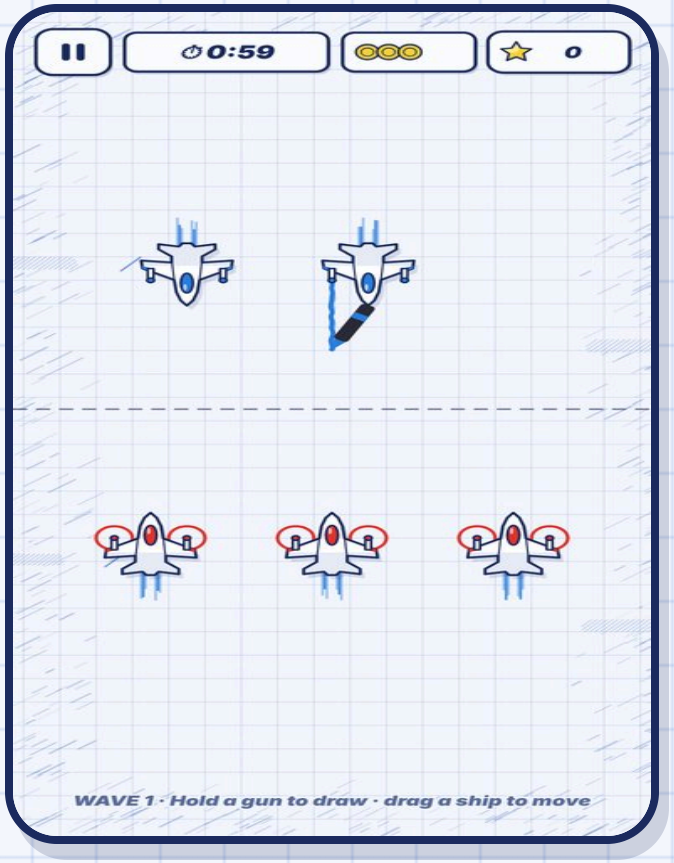
When your whole squadron is shot down, the **CONTINUE?** screen counts down from 10. Tap **CONTINUE** to spend a credit: your squadron comes back fully repaired and the fight goes on. Your score is kept.

No credits left, or the countdown reaches 0? **Game over**, and your score goes on the board.

Time Attack

Choose 60, 120, 180 seconds or **CUSTOM** (1–60 minutes). Longer runs get an **ATOMIC FLASH** every 3 minutes: everything freezes and the clock stops, then READY? and on you go. Clearing a wave adds **+5 s**. Stars depend on waves cleared: ★ 3+, ★★ 6+, ★★★ 10+. Best scores per duration are saved, and go to Google Play leaderboards.

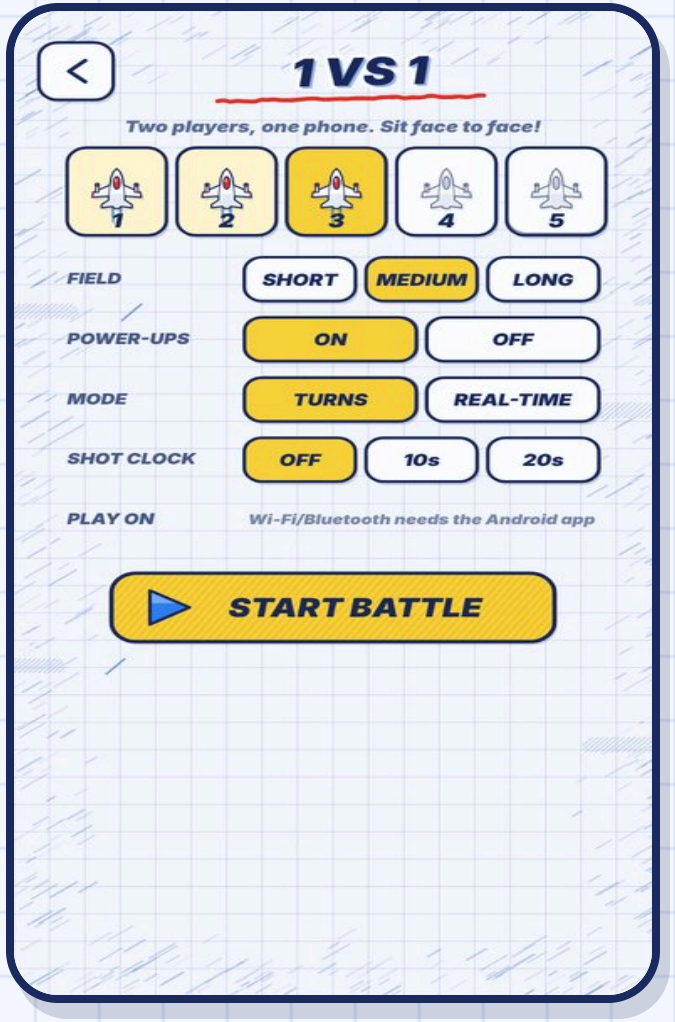


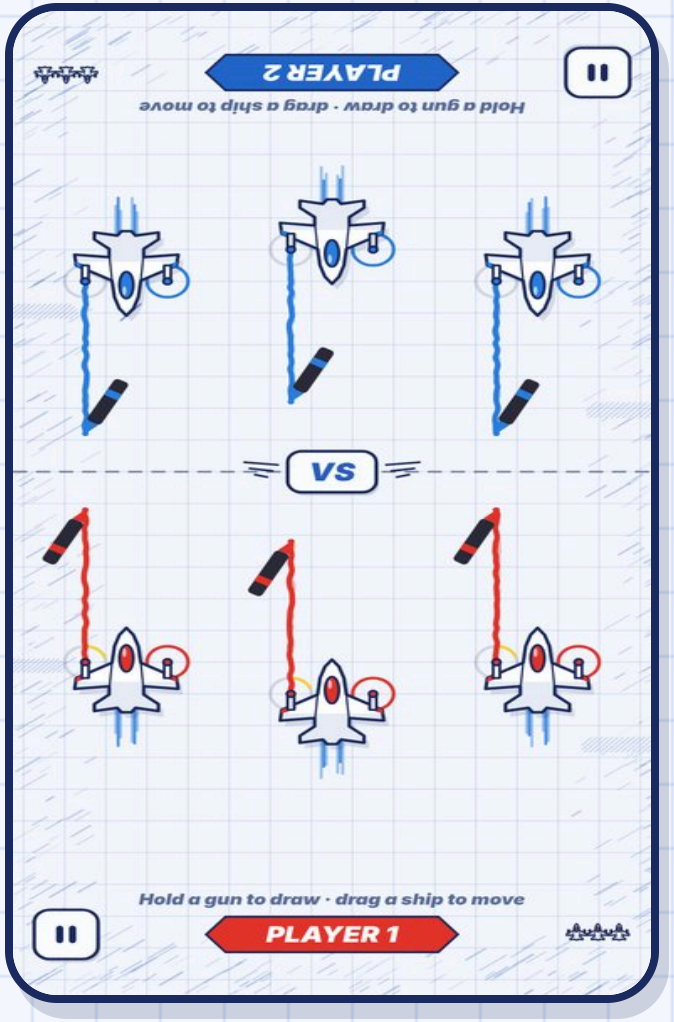


MULTIPLAYER

1VS1

Option	Choices
Names	Tap the red / blue name tags to type each pilot's name
Squadron	1 to 5 ships each
Field	Short · Medium · Long
Power-ups	On / Off
Mode	**Turns** (dice) or **Real-time** (both players draw at once, multitouch; Sudden Death after 90 s)
Shot clock	Off · 10 s · 20 s per turn. When the fuse burns down, the game plays your move for you.
Play on	One phone (Player 2's controls face the other way) or Wi-Fi / Bluetooth





MULTIPLAYER

Two phones: Wi-Fi / Bluetooth

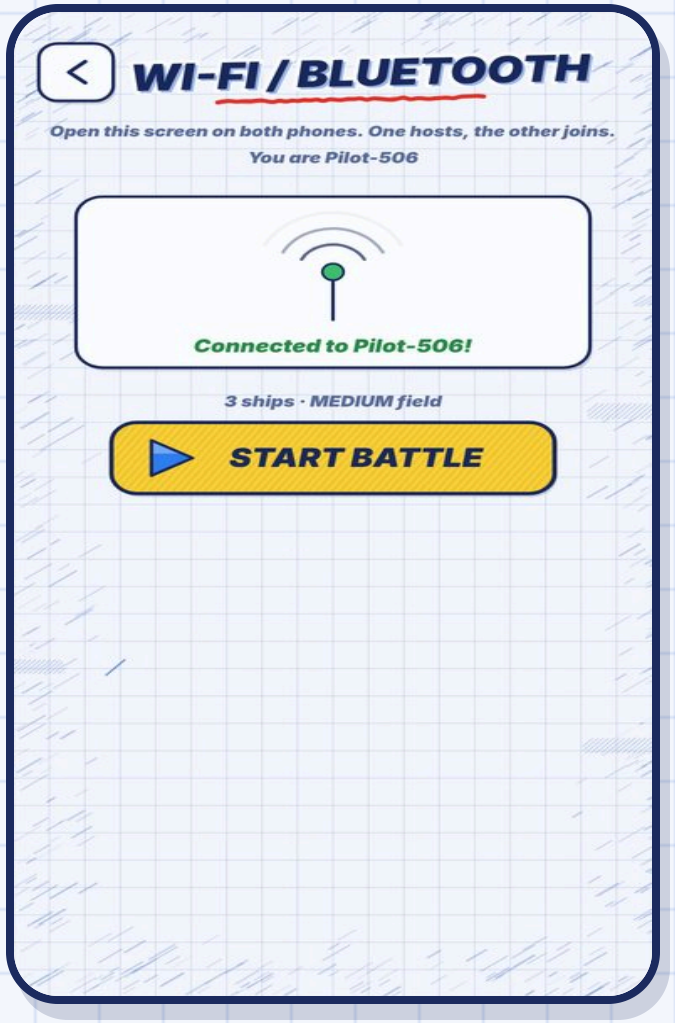
1. **Both open 1 VS 1**
   Set **Play on → Wi-Fi / Bluetooth** and tap **CONNECT**.

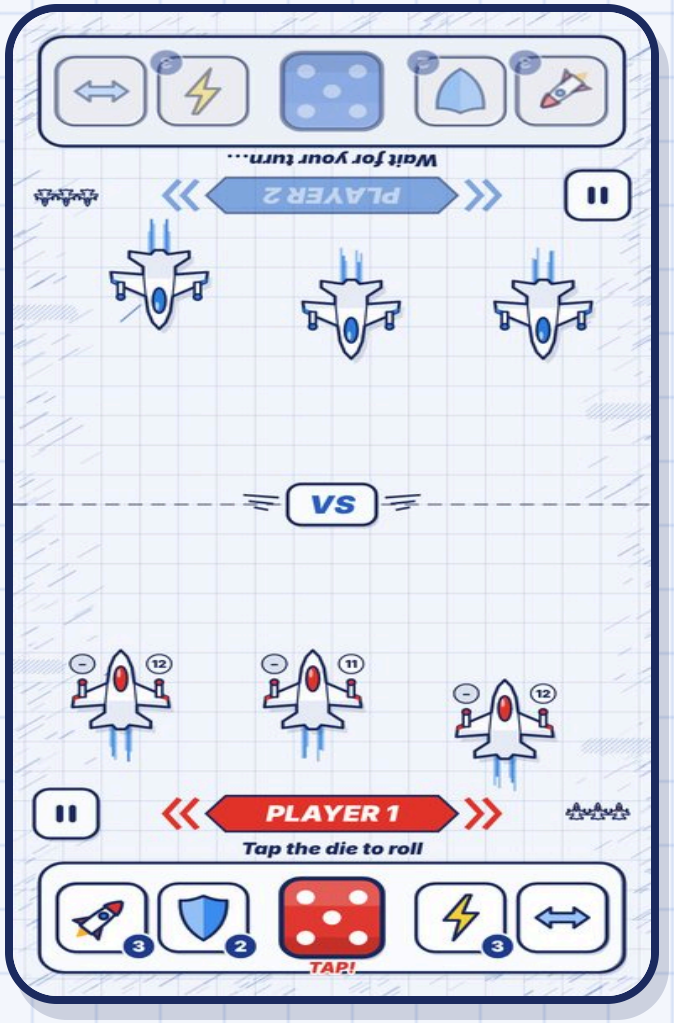
2. **One taps HOST, the other JOIN**
   Allow the Bluetooth / Nearby devices / Location permissions when asked. Android needs them to find nearby phones. No internet is used.

3. **Connected!**
   The host picks the settings (ships, field, power-ups, shot clock) and taps **START BATTLE**.

4. **Play**
   Each phone shows its own squadron at the bottom. After the battle the host can start a **REMATCH**.

Turn-based only. Keep the phones within a few metres of each other.





AWARDS

19 achievements

Tracked in the game (AWARDS on the main menu) and, when you sign in, on Google Play Games, together with the leaderboards for total stars, Arcade and Time Attack.

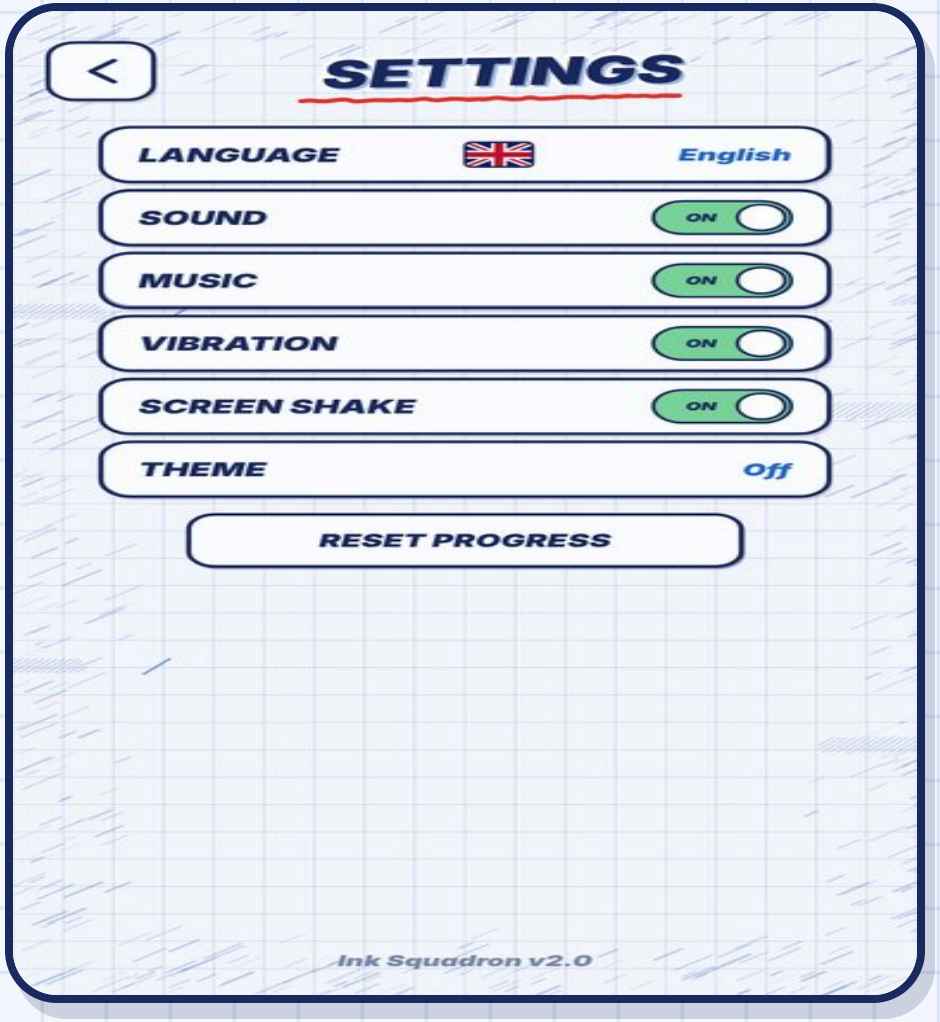
Award	How
First Victory	Win a Classic level
Flawless	Win a level without losing a ship
Boss Slayer	Destroy a boss
Cut Master	Cut 25 enemy missiles
Rocket Man	Destroy a ship with a rocket
Flak Gunner	Shoot down a bomber raid
Demolition	Destroy 20 bunker blocks
Veteran	Clear level 25
Ace	Clear level 50

Award	How
Legend	Clear level 100
Star Collector	Collect 100 stars
Arcade Hero	Reach wave 10 in Arcade
Balloon Buster	Pop 20 balloons in one bonus stage
Speed Demon	Score 5000 in Time Attack
Duelist	Win a 1 VS 1 battle
Wireless Ace	Win a Wi-Fi/Bluetooth battle
Spotter	Destroy every enemy ship type
Festive Pilot	Play during a seasonal event
Secret Squadron	??? Look closely at the main menu...

SETTINGS

Make it yours

Setting	
Language	English, 中文, Español, 日本語, Deutsch, Français, Italiano, Ελληνικά
Sound / Music	Effects and the C64 synthwave music, separately (or mute both with the menu speaker)
Vibration · Screen shake	Turn the rumble and the camera shake on or off
Co-pilot kid	Your little astronaut co-pilot pops up to cheer, warn and celebrate during battles and on the result screens. Turn him off here if you prefer a quiet cockpit.
Theme	**Auto** switches seasonal looks on by date: Halloween (Oct 15–Nov 2), Winter (Dec 10–Jan 7), Valentine (Feb 7–15), Summer (Jul–Aug). You can also pick one, or turn them Off.
Google Play Games	Sign in for achievements & leaderboards
Ad privacy	Change your ad consent choices at any time
Reset progress	Tap twice to start over



FROM THE FLIGHT SCHOOL

Tips & tricks

- Look for **nose lanes**: shots there can't be cut.
- When an enemy bubble on **your** ship turns small, **cut** it or put up a **shield**. Shields don't cost your turn!
- Save the **rocket** for the finishing blow: +6 squares with no dice luck.
- **Lightning** + a nearly finished missile often means two kills in one turn.
- A bomber raid is coming? Leave a long line in its path.
- Boss: take out the **engines** early, and it can't dodge anymore.
- Bunkers: break through where it opens a nose lane.
- Arcade: don't empty every gun at once. Keep ink for cutting. Hold a tail (not a gun) to dodge.
- Drag a ship out of a lane that is about to be hit.
- 1 VS 1 real-time: both players can cut, so watch the other side's ink rings!

The Back button pauses a battle. Leaving the app pauses it automatically.